

COC Provisions

Hospital shall continue providing Hospital Services to Members who, as determined by Blue Shield, qualify for completion of Covered Services under California Health & Safety Code Section 1373.96(c) ("Continuity of Care Services"), in accordance with the provisions therein.

Additional Information

California law provides for completion-of-covered-services/continuity-of-care for certain medical conditions following a provider's termination if, among other things, the provider and the Plan agree on a rate of payment. The current contract between Blue Shield of California and the terminating provider has provisions that cover members for continuity-of-care/completion-of-covered-services after the contract expires. It is always Blue Shield of California's intent to be prepared by having a Continuity-of-Care Agreement in place sufficient to meet the requirements of Health & Safety Code Section 1373.96(c). Blue Shield of California will comply with applicable requirements for completion-of-covered-services/continuity-of-care in accordance with the law. If a member began a course of treatment with the terminating provider before the contract expiration date for one of the following conditions, the member or his/her physician can request continuity-of-care by calling Blue Shield of California's Customer Service Department:

- Members in an active course of treatment for an acute medical or behavioral health condition, including a maternal mental health condition,
- Members in an active course of treatment for a serious chronic condition,
- Members who are pregnant, regardless of trimester,
- Members with a terminal illness,
- Members who are newborn children between the ages of birth and 36 months,
- Members with a surgery or other procedure that was authorized by Blue Shield or a delegated provider (i.e., HMO medical group) prior to the termination date and scheduled to occur within 180 days after the termination date.

Eligibility for continuity-of-care depends on factors outlined in the member's EOC. Continuity-of-care/completion-of-covered-services will be considered by Blue Shield's Continuity-of-Care Department on a case-by-case basis. When a case is approved, the claim(s) is/are processed at in-network benefit levels. Please note, HMO members and physicians wishing to request continuity-of-care/completion-of-covered-services would not contact Blue Shield because all medical management is delegated to the provider group. HMO members and physicians should contact their participating medical group/IPA.